MIL-B-36842A
25 September 1973
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-36842
15 June 1973

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BANDAGE, GAUZE, ELASTIC, 2 PLY, 3 INCHES BY 5 YARDS, 12s.

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a sterile, rubberless, elastic gauze bandage with self-adherent properties suitable for use in place of ordinary bandage rolls, bulk gauze rolls 4-1/2 inch 8 ply, special made rolls, and elastic bandage where excessive pressure is not required.

2 APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

PPP-B-566	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Box, Setup.

Military

MIL-S-36586	Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.

FSC 6510

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STANDARDS

Federal

FED-TEST-METHOD STD. No. 191	Textile Test Methods.

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

UNITED STATES PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

Pharmacopeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, Pennsylvania).

FEDERAL FOOD, DRUG, AND COSMETIC ACT AND REGULATIONS PROMULGATED THEREUNDER

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION, AND WELFARE

FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Food and Drug Administration, Washington, D. C. 20204).

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The bandage shall be fabricated from rubberless cotton gauze, U.S.P., Type VIII having a thread count of 14 warp yarns and 10 filling yarns per inch. A minus tolerance of 2 threads per inch shall apply. This gauze shall undergo treatment causing it to shrink and to have excess crimp in both directions. This gauze shall be self-adhering and stretchable. The thread count of the treated gauze shall be a minimum of 16 warp yarns and 14 filling yarns per inch. The minimum breaking strength shall be six pounds in the warp and five pounds in the filling when tested as specified in table II. The treated gauze shall comply with U.S.P. requirements for absorbency and the chemical properties described therein.

3.2 Color. The bandage shall be bleached white.

3.3 Construction. The finished bandage shall be such that one layer of the bandage shall be capable of clinging to an under layer. No adhesive or sizing materials shall be used in the manufacture of the bandage. The bandage shall be made by folding the cut treated gauze to two plies. This shall be done by turning the lateral edges toward each other to an abutting position, at approximately the center of the bandage. The fold shall not overlap or gap more than 3/8 inch $\pm$ 1/16 inch. The folded gauze shall be rolled with the folded edges to the outside of the roll. The edges of the rolled bandage shall be uniformly aligned. The gauze shall not be stretched in the roll, but shall be wound under sufficient tension to keep the roll from gapping. The bandage shall be one continuous piece and shall not be cut on the bias.

3.4 Dimensions. The width of the finished bandage shall be 3 inches $\pm$ 1/4 inch (unstretched). The length of the unstretched bandage, when measured within five minutes after unrolling, shall be not less than 118 inches long. The stretched length of the finished bandage at its breaking point shall average a minimum of 180 inches long, with no individual bandage measuring less than 160 inches long (see 4.5.2).

3.5 Sterility. The elastic gauze bandage shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.5.3. Each wrapped bandage shall be sterilized by steam sterilization.

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3.5.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item identification.
b. National stock number.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.5.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.6 Workmanship. The bandage shall be clean and free of loose threads, ravelings, and any defects which affect its appearance or may impair its serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

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4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.2 Sampling. Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified herein.

4.3 Component inspection. The treated gauze shall be tested in accordance with the current revision of the U.S.P. for absorbency and the chemical properties described therein. Sufficient quantity of the treated gauze shall be sampled from each lot of material to accomplish all determinations required by the test methods.

4.4 Examination of end item. The bandages shall be examined for visual and dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one bandage. The inspection level shall be S-4 of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality levels shall be 1.0 for major defects and 2.5 for minor defects, expressed in defects per hundred units (DHU). The defects found during this examination shall be classified as shown in table I.

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Table I. Classification of Defects

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Bandage not one continuous piece.
102	Bandage cut on bias.
103	Bandage, when unrolling, does not cling to under layer.
104	Bandage not clean (free of loose threads, raveling, or excessive lint).
105	Bandage not specified color.
106	Bandage not specified width (unstretched).
107	Bandage not specified length (unstretched).
Minor	
201	Bandage fold overlapping, or gapping more than specified.
202	Bandage not free of cuts holes or tears.
203	Bandage not folded as specified.

4.4.1 Bandage dimensions.

4.4.1.1 Length, unstretched. The bandage shall be laid out without tension on a smooth horizontal surface. The length shall be measured to the nearest 1/4 inch parallel to the edge using a yardstick, metal tape, or any other suitable measuring device.

4.4.1.2 Width, unstretched. The bandage width shall be measured to the nearest 1/8 inch using a ruler, metal tape, or any other suitable measuring device.

4.5 Testing of the end item. The end item shall be tested for the characteristics listed in table II. Except for sterility, the sample unit shall be two bandages. The inspection level shall be S-3 of MIL-STD-105, and the acceptable quality level shall be 1.5 defects per hundred units. The lot size shall be expressed in unit of issue. For sterility tests, the determinations shall be made on the sample unit from each lot or control number. The sample size shall be as described under sterility tests in the current revision of the Pharmacopeia of the United States. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet the test requirements.

4.5.1 The method of testing specified in Fed-Std-191, Textile Test Methods, wherever applicable, shall be followed, and as specified herein. All requirements are applicable to the sample unit. The number of determinations per sample unit shall be as required by the referenced test method.

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Table II. Test Methods

Characteristic	Requirement reference	Test method
Yarns per inch	3.1	5050
Breaking strength	3.1	5100 1/
Stretch length	3.4	para. 4.5.2
Sterility	3.5	para. 4.5.3

1/ The distance between the jaws of the tester shall be 1-1/2 inches apart at the start of test.

4.5.2 Stretched length test (referee method). The stretched length of the bandage shall be determined by placing one end of the bandage in a clamp, unrolling the bandage, and measuring the unstretched length. The loose end of the bandage shall be grasped and fully extended to its breaking point. This test is to be performed on a table with a one inch graduated scale measuring up to 190 inches. The stretched length shall be recorded on the test sheet and shall become a permanent inspection record.

4.5.2.1 Alternate stretched length test. An acceptable alternate test method for determining the stretched length of the bandage is to use the test apparatus shown in figure I (illustration only). The procedures are as follows:

(a) Unroll the two inch bandage. Secure one end of the bandage in the botton clamp of the machine.

(b) Extend the bandage from the bottom clamp up the back of the machine and over the two parallel rollers at the top of the machine; continue down the front and also secure the free end of the bandage in the bottom clamp to prevent slipping. Using a pencil or similar object, pull the bandage down between the two parallel rollers at the top and place under roller No. 3 which is approximately 12 inches below the two top rollers.

(c) Start and place the machine into gear, thus causing roller No. 3 to slowly descend and stretch the gauze. The instant the gauze breaks, disengage the gear which stops the third roller.

(d) The total stretched length of the bandage shall be read from the attached tape measure.

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4.5.3 Sterility test. The elastic gauze bandages shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the USP for purified cotton, gauze, surgical dressings and related material, using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in paragraph 4.5.3.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units. The inspection level shall be as indicated in paragraph 4.5.

4.5.3.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus, or	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.5.3.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.5.3 Sterility test and 4.5.3.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.5.3.1. NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP.

4.5.3.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

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4.5.3.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the U.S.P.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package (12 bandages), as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in table III shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table III. Packaging quantities

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1 unit	12 units	48 units

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units may be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Individual package. Each rolled bandage shall be contained in a paper wrapper and carton that will retain sterility of contents until manually opened.

5.1.3.2 Unit package. Unit package shall be a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676, except commercial colors will be acceptable. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.3.3 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather resistant. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix, and waterproofing shall conform with 30.4 of PPP-B-636.

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5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for type 2 load, and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather resistant. Closure and strapping shall be in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall conform to PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be method II as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Individual package. Each individual package shall bear the item identification; Bandage, Gauze, Elastic, 2-ply, name of manufacturer, lot or control number, and the legend "Sterile", and "Sterility void if package is broken" or a similar statement.

5.3.2 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetics Act. Contract or purchase order number, sterility lot (control) number and name and address of the manufacturer shall be shown. When the manufacturer is not the contractor, the name and address of the contractor shall also be shown. The method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat Sterilization) shall be shown following the level of packaging and the date of packaging. Example: "A9/69-G".

5.3.3 Intermediate package. Each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. The method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2 shall be shown. Sterility lot (control) number, contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.4 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. The sterility lot (control) number shall be shown. The method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2 shall also be shown. NOTE. Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The gauze, elastic bandage covered by this specification is intended for use in place of ordinary bandage rolls, bulk gauze rolls, special made rolls, and elastic bandages, where excessive pressure is not required.

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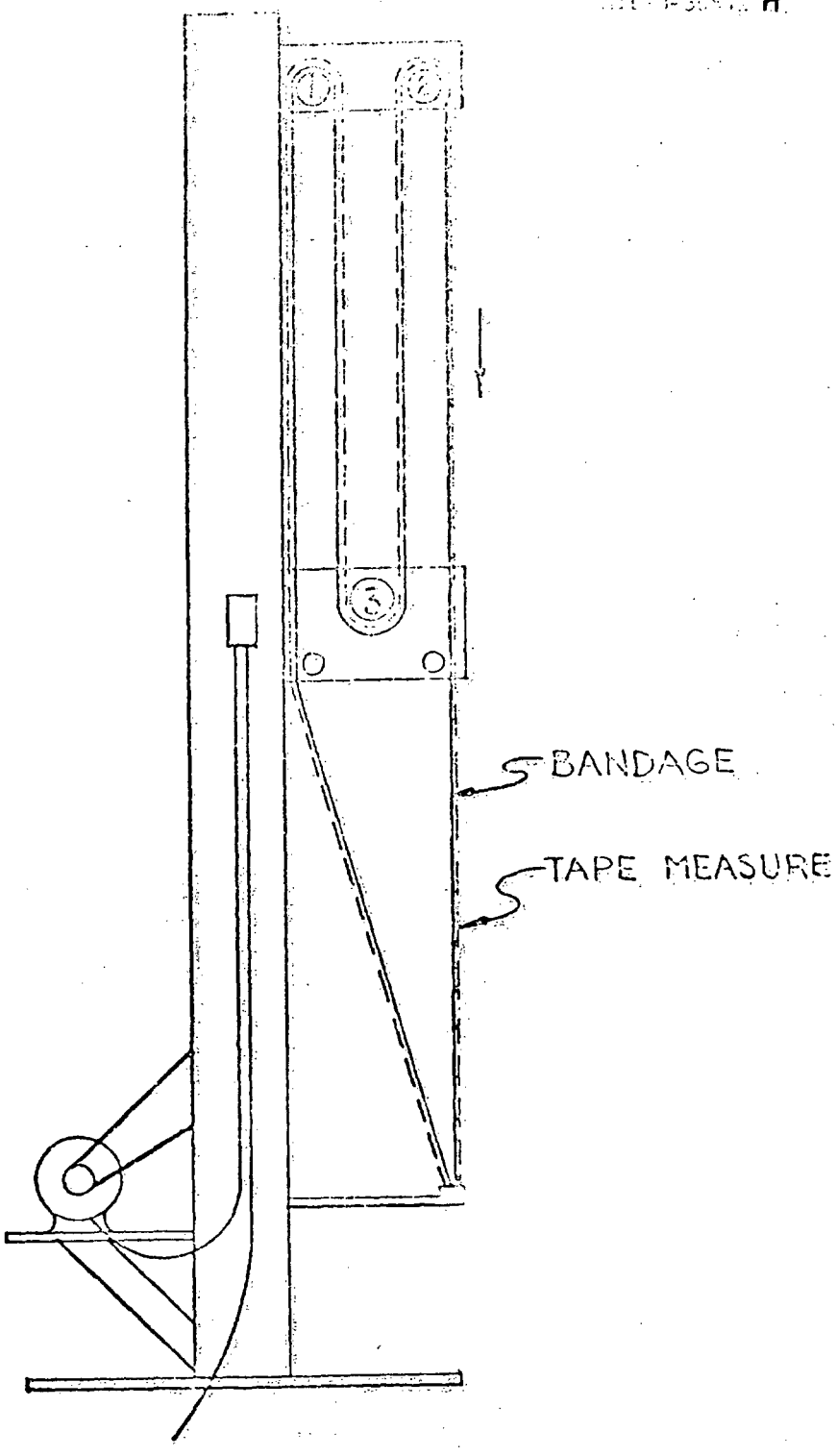


FIGURE 1 STRETCH TEST APPARATUS

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.

(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 The bandage covered by this specification, is listed in the Federal Supply Catalog under the following stock number:

NSN	Item Identification
6510-00-582-7993	BANDAGE, GAUZE, ELASTIC, 2 Ply, 3 Inches by 5 Yards, 12s.

6.4 This specification does not include all types or sizes as indicated by the title nor all types which are commercially available.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6510-0587

Review information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current DODISS.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
MIL-B-36842A

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?
   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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